MICHEL POHL

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Personal Website – Blog
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Hugging Face – Google Scholar

Machine learning researcher and engineer

SKILLS

- **Tech:** Python (TensorFlow, PyTorch, Transformers, Optuna, scikit-learn, pandas), C, Matlab, Linux, Git, Docker, AWS
- **Communication:** French (native), English (fluent), Japanese (JLPT N2)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Algorithm researcher, **Brainomix** (United Kingdom, Oxford) Dec 2022–current

- Developed and deployed a respiratory phase classifier for chest CT using shape features from deep learning-based trachea/lung segmentations, supporting in-house imaging biomarker reliability. Investigated model explainability by examining feature importance, PDPs and ICE plots.
- Conducted survival analysis using random survival forests and Cox proportional hazards models to assess segmentation quality and biomarker predictive power. Improved ML validation workflows in CI/CD by automating survival analysis and reducing mean runtime by 11%.
- Improved trachea/lung segmentation postprocessing using a level-set-based method, reducing worst-case lung volume estimation error by 26%
- Explored denoising algorithms such as guided filtering for robust airway segmentation, improving Dice score by 0.055 at specific noise levels

Visiting researcher, **Sony Computer Science Laboratories** (Tokyo / remote) June–Nov 2022

- Researched NLP algorithms, including LSTMs and transformer-based models (BERT and MPNet), using **TensorFlow/PyTorch** for fake-news detection, ESG risk-score regression, and evaluation of fund-report alignment with ESG criteria to support Nomura Asset Management
- Designed an interpretable method for fund-level greenwashing detection by deriving projection-distance formulas to compare neural embeddings of internal sustainability reports and external news in a subspace defined using ESG criteria
- Developed an optical-flow-inspired method to estimate time-varying loadings in security factor models and trained a VAE to learn and visualize low-dimensional fund-exposure embeddings from per-stock active weights and loadings, supporting GPIF, a major Japanese pension fund

Computer vision research intern, **Idemia**, *Research and Technology Unit* (France, Île-de-France) Apr–Sept 2016

- Prototyped an end-to-end OCR pipeline in **C** for degraded text images—segmentation, character recognition, and shortest-path graph decoding using Viterbi's algorithm to select the most likely string—achieving 13.4% higher accuracy than Tesseract 3.04, an open-source OCR engine
- Designed a method for character over-segmentation (i.e., candidate cut generation) based on Dijkstra's algorithm, modeling the image as a graph with pixels as nodes and edge weights derived from intensities and heuristics; reduced time complexity via a binary-search-style strategy
- Implemented a character-level neural-network classifier from scratch (~50k parameters) as part of the OCR pipeline and trained it on ~20k synthetic character images; improved accuracy by ~5% by incorporating a class-conditional Bayesian aspect-ratio prior

Physics research intern, **Schlumberger**, *Engineering department* (Japan, Kanagawa) Jan–Feb 2014 and June–Aug 2014

- Modeled fluid flow with PDEs and solved them via harmonic/asymptotic analysis to assess vibration-sensor feasibility for reservoir evaluation

EDUCATION

M.Sc. and Ph.D. in Bioengineering, **The University of Tokyo** (Japan) Sept 2016–Sept 2021

- Derived implementations of online training algorithms for RNNs with improved accuracy and complexity; applied them to marker-position forecasting for latency compensation in radiotherapy, achieving competitive results with less training data than prior deep-learning approaches
- Developed a data-efficient, modular, and interpretable image-forecasting algorithm for MR-guided radiotherapy, combining deformable image registration, PCA-based motion modeling, and temporal dynamics prediction with online-trained RNNs and transformers in PyTorch/Matlab
- Published 4 articles in Q1 CS journals and 1 article chosen as an Editors' Pick in "Towards Data Science"; the 2 most recent papers extend my Ph.D. work with new algorithms/data and experiments (e.g., ablation/statistical analyses) conducted during independent research (2022–2026)
- Presented my research at 12 conferences in Japan (where I won 2 prizes), one workshop at Seoul National University, and in 1 YouTube video with ~ 450k views

Additional coursework (M.Sc. in Mathematics—1st year), **Aix-Marseille Université** (France, distance learning) 2017–2019

- Coursework in probability theory, parametric and non-parametric statistics, stochastic processes, partial differential equations...

M.Sc. in Engineering ("Diplôme d'ingénieur"), **Centrale Lille** (France) 2013–2016

- Implemented a classifier for graph-structured data based on a generalized likelihood-ratio test and Fourier graph transforms, and applied it to Alzheimer's disease diagnosis from PET images by modeling brain regions as graph nodes (3-month project at Fresnel Institute, tech: **Matlab**)
- Built and programmed autonomous robots for the 2015 French robotics contest (2-year project with 5 other students, tech: Arduino, **C**)

Joint M.Sc.(Res) in Signal and Image Processing, **Centrale Méditerranée** (France), Valedictorian award (video in French) 2015–2016

- Research-oriented program in AI and computer vision: Bayesian statistics, wavelet analysis, Markov models, segmentation, image restoration...

B.Sc. in Mathematics, Physics and Computer Science ("Classes préparatoires"), **Lycée Louis-le-Grand**, (France) 2010–2013

- Highly selective undergraduate science program preparing for nationwide competitive examinations for entry to the best French universities

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- Sept 2018–Sept 2021 : The University of Tokyo Doctoral Student Special Incentives Program (SEUT-RA)
- Sept 2019–Sept 2020 : SEUT-RA Type A (top 20 applicants in the 2nd year of the Ph.D. program at the Graduate School of Engineering)
- April 2019–April 2021 : scholarship from the Epson International Scholarship Foundation
- March 2018 & March 2019: idea prize and encouragement prize (annual meeting and students' meeting of the Atomic Energy Society of Japan)
- Sept 2016–March 2017 and Sept 2017–March 2018 : JASSO Honors Scholarship for Privately-Financed International Students